



Virtual Defence Debate Programme

Social Media and Fifth Generation Warfare

A Personality Development & Assessment-Oriented Programme for SSB Aspirants

About the Programme

The **Virtual Defence Debate Programme on “Social Media and Fifth Generation Warfare”** is a structured, assessment-oriented online event designed to develop and observe officer-like qualities among defence aspirants. Organised by a student-led initiative from **NIT Jalandhar**, this programme aims to simulate the behavioural and psychological environment that candidates encounter during the **Services Selection Board (SSB)** interview.

The focus of the programme is not merely debate performance, but the evaluation of **personality traits, clarity of thought, communication skills, group behaviour, leadership potential, and composure under discussion-based pressure** — all of which form the core of SSB assessment.

Theme of the Programme

Social Media and Fifth Generation Warfare

Modern warfare has evolved beyond conventional battlefields. Information dominance, narrative control, psychological influence, and cyber space now play a decisive role in national security. This programme uses the theme of **Social Media and Fifth Generation Warfare (5GW)** to encourage participants to:

- Analyse contemporary security challenges
- Express informed and balanced opinions
- Demonstrate strategic thinking and situational awareness
- Communicate responsibly on sensitive national and social issues

The topic is intentionally chosen to reflect **defence relevance, analytical depth, and interview-level discussion**, rather than routine debate themes.

Debate Point Hints (Indicative Only)

To maintain analytical depth while avoiding pre-scripted arguments, participants are advised to use the following hints only as guiding directions, not exhaustive points. These hints are intended to help candidates understand the breadth of discussion without revealing complete viewpoints.

- Digital Influence & Democracy: Role of social media in shaping public opinion and electoral behaviour
- Information as a Weapon: Use of narratives and misinformation to influence internal stability
- Personal Data & National Security: Risks arising from oversharing images, locations, and personal details
- Youth & Cognitive Impact: Effect of short-form digital content on focus, discipline, and thinking ability
- Freedom vs Regulation: Balancing free speech with security and social responsibility
- Military & Media Discipline: Why armed forces impose restrictions on social media usage
- Future Conflict Models: Transition from conventional warfare to information-driven and next-generation warfare
- These hints are deliberately brief to encourage original thinking, situational awareness, and mature reasoning, qualities expected in future officers.

Relevance to SSB Assessment

Participation in this programme directly contributes to improvement in:

Psychological Tests

- **PPDT** – Observation, interpretation, and structured narration
- **WAT / VAT** – Clarity of expression, positivity, and speed of response

- **Story Writing** – Logical flow and realistic situational handling

GTO Tasks

- **Group Discussion** – Effective participation and cooperation
- **Lecturette** – Structured speaking and content depth
- **Group Interaction** – Social adaptability and leadership behaviour

Personal Interview

- Clear articulation of views
- Confidence in expressing opinions
- Mature handling of counter-questions

Programme Structure

The event will be conducted in a disciplined and professional manner, closely resembling group-based assessment environments.

- Formal opening and briefing
- Ice-breaker interaction round
- Main moderated debate session
- Rapid opinion and response round
- Self-reflection segment
- Concluding feedback and result declaration

Assessment Parameters & Mark Distribution

Participants will be observed and evaluated on the following parameters. The marking system is designed to reflect **SSB-style personality assessment**, where clarity of thinking and communication carry the highest weightage.

Assessment Area	Marks
Clarity of Thought & Relevancy of Content	30
Communication Ability & Language Control	30
Behaviour & Social Effectiveness	10
Initiative, Confidence & Leadership	20
Discipline, Structure & Time Management	10
Total	100

The evaluation philosophy prioritises **balance, maturity, and officer-like conduct**, not aggressive speaking or fluency alone.

Rewards and Recognition

Outstanding performers will be offered **one of the following rewards (choice-based)**:

- **Two times (2×) refund of the registration fee OR**
- **A recommended SSB preparation book** (Interview / Psychology / GTO-oriented) **OR**
- **A Zomato / Pizza voucher coupon** (food delivery or dining)

All participants will receive formal recognition of participation, adding value to their SSB preparation profile.

PIQ Form Value

Participation and achievement in this programme may be reflected in the **Personal Information Questionnaire (PIQ)** under extracurricular and personality development activities, indicating:

- Initiative beyond academics
- Engagement in defence-oriented discussions
- Development of communication and leadership skills

Such entries contribute to portraying a **dynamic and proactive personality**, which is a key focus of SSB assessment.

Event Details

- **Date:** 28 January
- **Mode:** Virtual (Google Meet)
- **Nature:** Moderated Defence-Oriented Debate Programme

Meeting link and reporting instructions will be shared with registered participants prior to the event.

Discipline & Conduct

To maintain a professional assessment environment, participants are expected to:

- Join the meeting on time
- Keep camera switched on throughout the session
- Maintain respectful and disciplined conduct
- Follow speaking instructions and time limits

Organising Body & Contact Details

This programme is organised by a **student-led club from the National Institute of Technology (NIT), Jalandhar**, with the objective of creating defence-relevant platforms for personality development and leadership cultivation among youth.

Organising Committee: - Led by **Anand**

Contact Details: - **Email:** anand.tarang.nitj@gmail.com

Technical support: satyamgoswami2705@gmail.com

Phone: 9792950614

WhatsApp: 9792950614

(Official contact details will be shared for participant communication and coordination.)

Guiding Thought

“Modern warfare begins in the mind. Leadership begins with clarity, character, and communication.”

Train the mind. Refine expression. Prepare for selection.